# BLOOM · keys at home

? shows the keys on screen · cmd Z undoes anything · page 2: list modes, freezes, ideas

## PLAY

| | |
|---|---|
| space | play once (every list starts at its beginning) |
| , | loop (lists phase against each other) |
| / | pulsar: replay every few beats |
| < > | pulsar slower / faster |
| . | stop everything |
| ⇧ space | play the selected garden slot |
| opt , | loop / pulse the whole garden |
| opt / | |
| ~ | sustain pedal |
| ` | record / stop |

## NEW, UNDO, SAVE POINTS

| | |
|---|---|
| n | new bloom |
| N | new bloom, same scale |
| b | new shape |
| B | new bloom, same scale and shape |
| cmd z | undo (last 300 changes) |
| cmd ⇧ z | redo |
| opt p | push a save point |
| opt P | pop back to it |
| cmd S | save / load the garden to a file (or the buttons top right) |
| cmd O | |

## GESTURES · whole bloom, small steps

| | |
|---|---|
| − | **calm**: merge a note, soften, pitches inward |
| = | **intensify**: split a note, louder, pitches outward |
| ' | **vary**: a little of everything moves |
| { } | merge two notes / split one in half |

Rhythm only splits and merges, so the total length and your durations (halves and doubles) survive.

**A bloom is five lists**

**pitch** (a sub-list is a chord) · **time** to the next note, in beats · **velocity** (0 = rest) · **channel** · **intervals**. Each list can have its own length.

**Phasing**

Lists of different lengths cycle on their own: 5 pitches over 4 velocities shift the accent each time round. You hear it in the **loop** and **pulsar**; space always starts every list together. L shows a cursor per list.

## WHOLE NOTES · each keeps its time, vel, chan

| | |
|---|---|
| s S | scramble / perfect shuffle |
| R | mirror |
| 9 0 | rotate ← → |
| u U | stutter / sputter |
| d D | braid / pyramid |
| Y r | spray / ratchet |
| h H | thin / thicken |
| g G | insert / remove a gap |
| z | drop last |
| a A | add a note: in the scale / any |
| ; : | clump into chords / flatten chords |
| W | remove doubled notes |
| opt w | wheels within wheels: one accent drifting each cycle |

opt + s S R u U d D: the same patterns on the pitches only.

## PITCH · also in pitch mode

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 2 | semitone down / up |
| ! @ | octave down / up |
| 3 4 | scale step down / up |
| # $ | **breeze**: some notes a step down / up |
| m M | mutate: in the scale / chromatic |
| i I | invert / invert around the mean |
| ( ) | **pivot**: invert, keeping the highest / loudest note |
| e E | shear / center the range |
| w | draw a contour (in the scale) |
| o O | sort pitches up / down |

## SCALES AND KEYS · also in pitch mode

| | |
|---|---|
| k | snap to the nearest named scale |
| K | **slant**: a neighbouring scale, any root |
| [ ] | one step **flatward / sharpward** (circle of fifths) |
| j | lift the garden slot's scale |
| J | reduce the scale |

**Home or mode?**

Home keys act on **whole notes** or the whole bloom; a mode applies the same verb to **one list**. s at home scrambles notes with their rhythm; t then s scrambles only the rhythm.

## GARDEN · the row of slots

| | |
|---|---|
| ↓ | save the bloom into the slot |
| opt ↓ | insert it here, the rest slide right |
| ↑ | lift the slot into the bloom |
| ← → | move · with ⇧, move and play |
| ↵ ⌫ | new slot / clear slot |
| x X | interlace / blend with the slot |
| f | take the slot's rhythm, dynamics, channels |
| C | cast: your pitch classes on the slot's contour and rhythm |
| \| | merge the garden into the bloom |
| opt \| | curdle: the bloom into the garden |

## MODES AND MENUS

| | |
|---|---|
| p t v c 5 | pitch, time, velocity, channel, intervals mode (page 2) |
| esc | back home |

## FREEZE · F, then…

| | |
|---|---|
| p | pitch: lock to the scale |
| t r | rhythm: the durations in use |
| v | dynamics: the levels in use |
| c | channels in use |
| 5 | intervals: the steps in use |
| d | total duration: trim → stretch → off |
| g | time grid |

The menu stays open so you can set several; F or esc closes. The header shows what's frozen, e.g. ❄ **p t d:trim**.

## VIEW

| | |
|---|---|
| L | lanes: every list, each with its own cursor |
| l | note labels |
| opt 1–9 | picture style |
| opt c | clean view for video (esc leaves) |
| \ | console |
| opt e | edit the bloom as text |
| cmd k | command palette: every operation by name |

## INTERVALS · notes added at playback

| | |
|---|---|
| 5 | **intervals mode** (randomize there with n) |
| 6 ^ | widen / narrow |
| 7 & | add / drop a step |
| 8 | reset (nothing added) |
| % | count in semitones ↔ scale steps |
| * | bake into the notes as chords |

# BLOOM · list modes

p t v c 5 enter a mode · its key or esc goes home · another mode key switches across

In a mode every key acts on **that one list**; the others stay put. A key means the same verb in every mode. Play, garden, view, undo and F work as usual; anything else just shows a hint.

| KEY | VERB | PITCH P | TIME T | VELOCITY V | CHANNELS C | INTERVALS 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| s S R 9 0 u U d D | scramble, shuffle, mirror, rotate, stutter, sputter, braid, pyramid: **the same in every list**. Changing one list's length makes it phase against the others. | | | | | |
| o O | sort up / down | low → high | short → long | crescendo | low → high | close → wide |
| z a A | drop last / add | add in scale / any | add one from the palette / at random | | | add a step in use / a fresh one |
| 1 2 | down / up | semitone | faster / slower ×1.2 | softer / louder | channel ∓1 | every interval ∓1 |
| ! @ | big down / up | octave | double / half time | much softer / louder | — | an octave across (+7 ↔ –5) |
| 3 4 | one palette step | scale step | next duration you use | next level you use | next channel in use | next size in use |
| # $ | breeze | as 3 4, but only some values move, and the same ones tend to keep moving | | | | |
| – = | converge / diverge | narrower / wider range | evener / more uneven | flatter / wider dynamics | toward / away from the main channel | narrower / wider |
| y | unify | all the commonest pitch | all the commonest duration | all the average level | all the main channel | all the commonest step |
| i / I | invert / around the middle | high ↔ low / around the mean | long ↔ short | loud ↔ quiet | across the range / around the main | above ↔ below / wide ↔ close |
| e | shear | tilt up or down | accel. or rit. | dynamic ramp | drift across channels | closing in or opening out |
| w | curve | contour | rubato | hairpins | smooth path | swell of widths |
| m M | mutate gently / wildly | scale steps / chromatic | from the palette / anything | | | |
| h H | fewer / more distinct values | one pitch class fewer / more | durations | levels | channels | kinds of step |
| q / Q | quantize / choose the setting | snap to the scale | to the grid / pick grid | to at most N levels / pick N | | at most N kinds of step |
| n | new list | new pitches | new times (from the palette) | new dynamics | new channels | new intervals |
| x / f | with the garden slot | lace this list with the slot's / copy the slot's | | | | |
| **Only in pitch mode** | every pitch key from home: ( ) pivot · [ ] flatward / sharpward · k K j J scales · E center · and 9 0 rotates the pitches alone | | | | | |
| **Also in pitch & intervals mode** | 6 ^ 7 & 8 % * mean what they mean at home | | | | | |

### Palette

The distinct values a list already uses: your durations, dynamic levels, channels, interval steps. For pitch, the palette is the scale. “Step” keys move **along your own vocabulary**, so a groove of 1, ½, ¼ stays in halves and doubles.

### How a freeze works

Switching one on takes a **snapshot** of what the list uses now. Anything outside it then **snaps to the nearest** allowed value: on every play, and after every change while a loop or pulsar runs.

Snapping rewrites the bloom; unfreezing doesn't undo it. Freeze again for a new snapshot.

### Undo vs save points

cmd z steps back **one change at a time**. opt p marks a place you like; wander as far as you want and opt P jumps straight back. The **notice** top-left names each change for 5 s.

### Breeze

# $ move only **some** values a step. Notes that just moved are likelier to move again, so repeated presses drift a line rather than shuffle the whole thing.

### Intervals

Each step adds notes **above (+) or below (–)** the note it falls on, at playback; 0 adds nothing. They count semitones or scale steps (%). The list cycles at its own length, so harmony phases too. * writes them into the notes as chords.

### Moving through keys

K **slant** jumps to a near-neighbour scale on any root and avoids the last few it visited, so it wanders outward.

[ ] travel **steadily**: one scale note moves a semitone per press, C → G → D… sharpward or the reverse.

### Pivot and pitch classes

( ) turn the melody upside down while the highest (or loudest) note stays put.

In pitch mode h H remove or add one **pitch class**; the scale follows.